

which is probably meaningful, and convert it into something that holds no possible meaning whatsoever, by the use of an encoding algorithm. The key to the uniqueness of the process (so as to ensure that every attack is isolated, and fallacies of one nod do not affect another), is funnily enough, called the ‘key’. It is the parameter without which the strongest of decryption algorithms, cannot decipher the data into its original, meaningful state. Unless, of course, they are run for an unrealistic number of times, or on an unrealistic number of machines, or both.

Some of you might have heard about hashing, though a lot might have not. In the interest of the forthcoming context, it would be good if we could introduce that here too.

Hashing

Mistaking hashing for an encryption technique is one of the most basic mistakes that people seem to make. What hashing is is basically a mapping of large chunks of data into tables that contain references to those chunks, thereby containing a virtual representation of all of the data that was initially provided. It, in no way, is related to any matter of encryption, even though there is abundant use of a ‘key’ here. Again – it bears no relation to the encryption key.

md5	7e0f0cc9351b24982a259cd995d4a18	mailing	01044	2009-11-11 10:05:10
md5	849f0eac1f92b72107b0baf6d33ac73a9	mailing	01047	2009-11-11 10:05:10
md5	0b50b5bd11a0a0a0ad07aa1d9333ad443a	mailing	01118	2009-11-11 10:06:19
md5	78c8acbd2312460fa081fde23fb1d7c6e	mailing	01268	2009-11-11 10:12:09
md5	c321f98bd94bd3ad4a3d37ac288185	preprocessing.F	01254	2009-11-11 09:10:13
md5	c8f63831aff130a0a0a052a0b327380f	preprocessing.F	014129	2009-11-11 09:59:04
md5	a79c87bd78c3c8a37932306aac97837f	cracked	01041	2009-11-11 09:01:01
md5	a7961c94d22777a3f993a4a50b41c00e	preprocessing.F	015718	2009-11-11 09:40:59
md5	2a7316360a0a933a0a31230b1521a4057	preprocessing.F	015719	2009-11-11 09:40:41
md5	a333a372131023a95dc277c3c638235bd	preprocessing.F	01572	2009-11-11 09:10:18
md5	d11ad0a73c95253343f4821b3b4740ba1	cracked	010428	2009-11-11 09:40:41
md5	d922a0da07ac93632ac219f7172819	preprocessing.F	01638	2009-11-11 09:13:03
md5	5c12493a0d12480a03359922334fd0a	preprocessing.F	01632	2009-11-11 09:12:03
md5	772a0f8d271a0792a0f0a0a0a10179a	cracked	01012	2009-11-11 09:10:19
md5	85d95a2a013b6d954bd1521a010a2749	cracked	0102	2009-11-11 09:10:29
md5	340a2c72794054a2c25f0b9a0d2a40f	preprocessing.F	01156	2009-11-11 09:12:11
md5	0aa13b0d095940a0a069422240a0d7933	cracked	010619	2009-11-11 09:02:34
md5	5ac10107410b1140737622a0a01010f	cracked	010113	2009-11-11 09:02:34

Now, you might have heard about the encryption being considered as weak, these days. Believe us, we’ve met “hackers” who think it’s a piece of cake to break the general encryption algorithms. To put such claims into some perspective, we’d take the liberty of putting up some tech folklore here.

There are times when you come across people claiming that encryption algorithms that are commonly used can be breached. We’ve long considered it a classic giveaway for shallow tech-hipsters. While it is true that some of